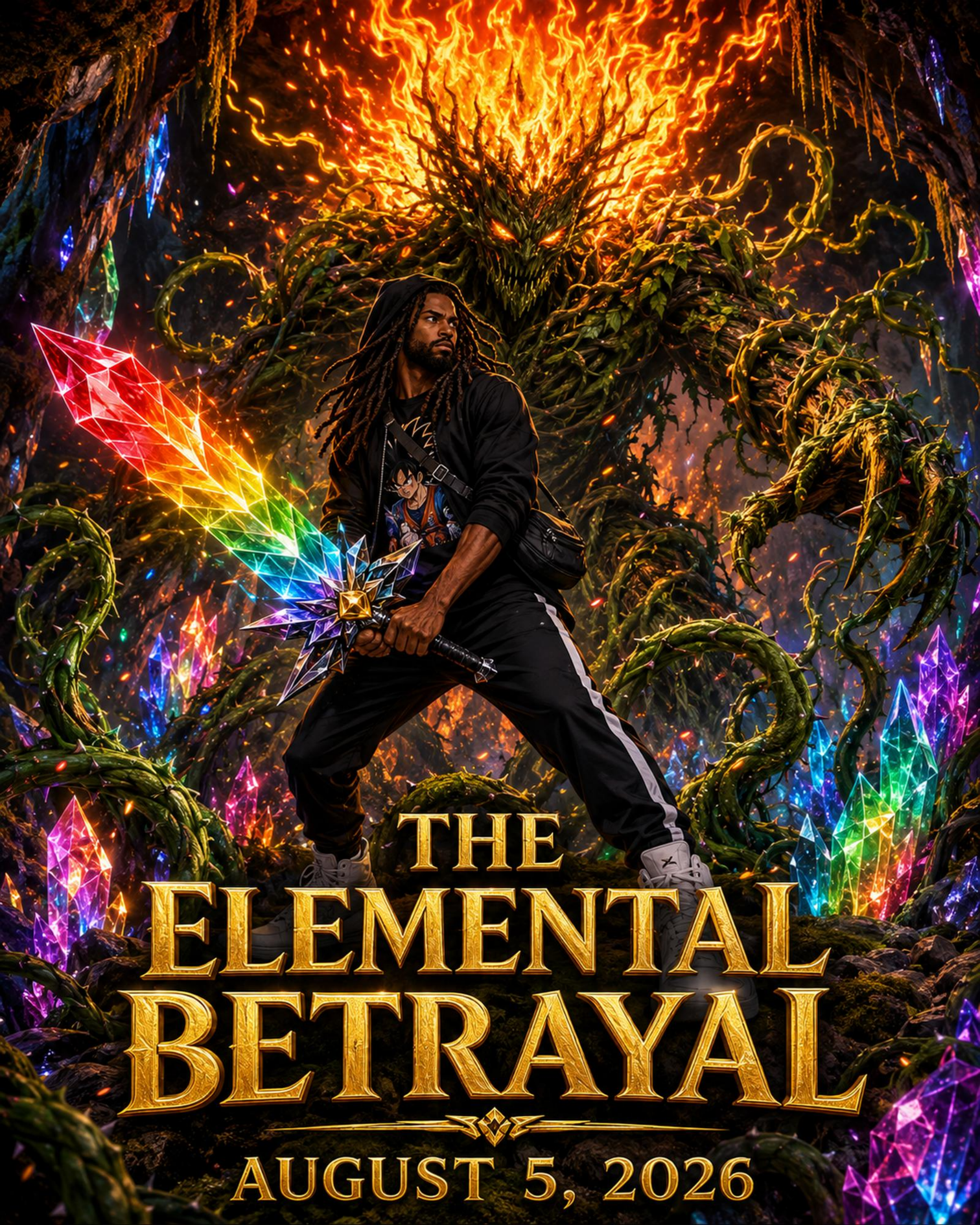
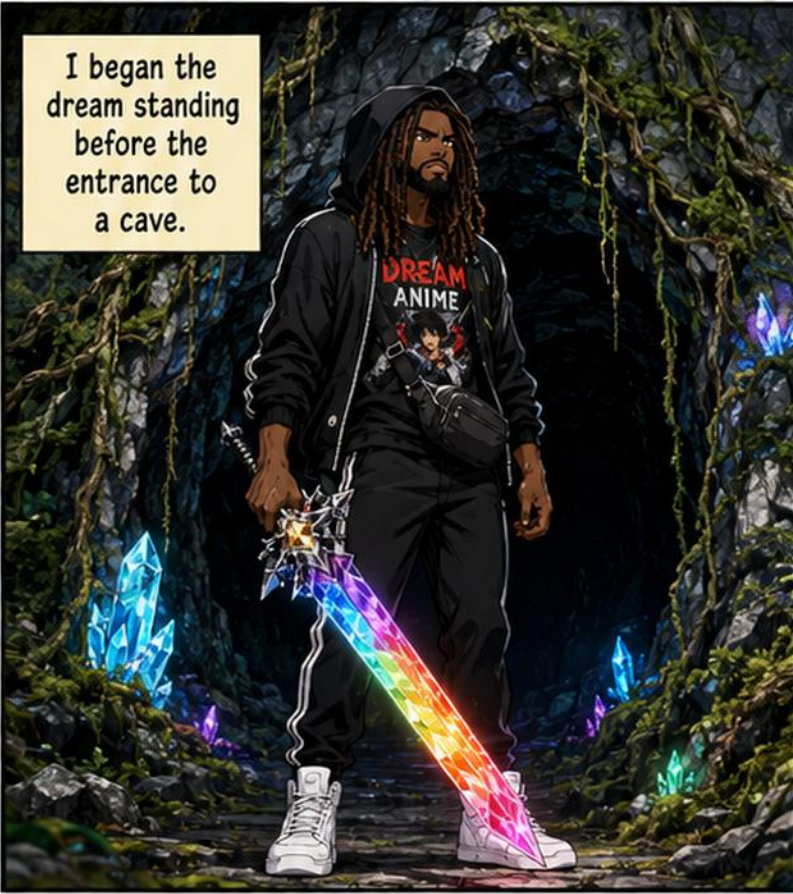




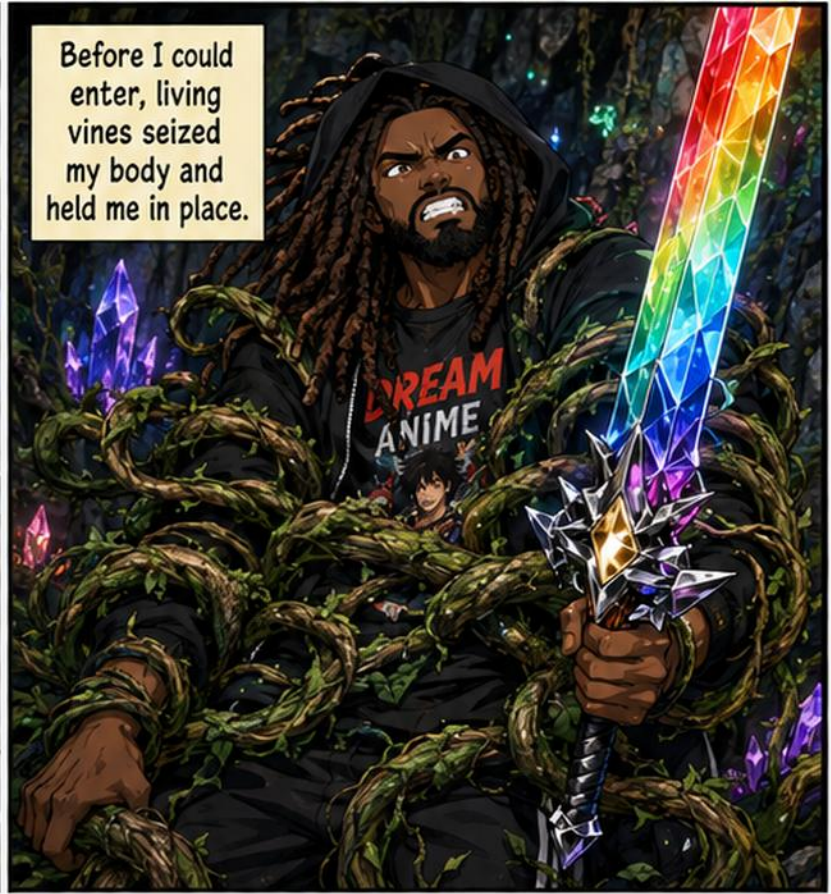
THE ELEMENTAL BETRAYAL

AUGUST 5, 2026

I began the dream standing before the entrance to a cave.



Before I could enter, living vines seized my body and held me in place.



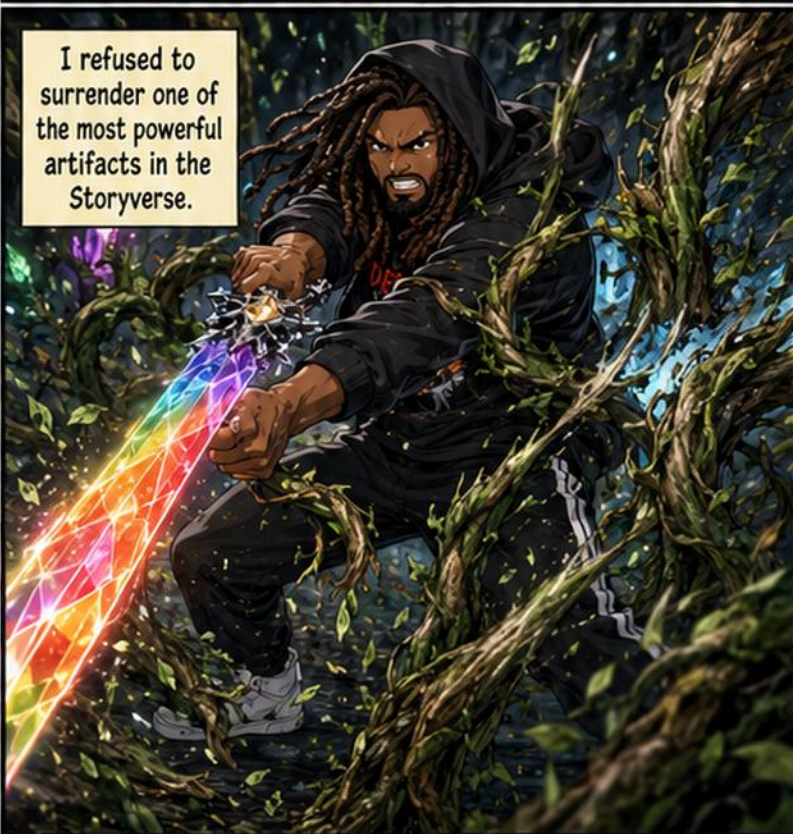
They belonged to a humanoid vine elemental crowned with living fire.



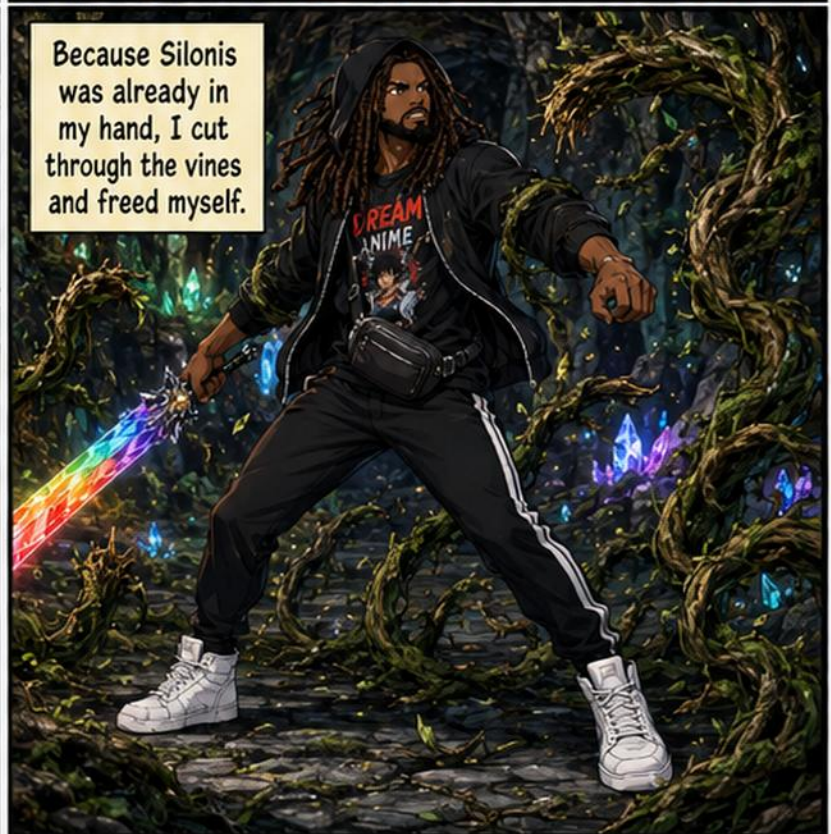
The elemental demanded Silonis, my rainbow crystal Life Sword.



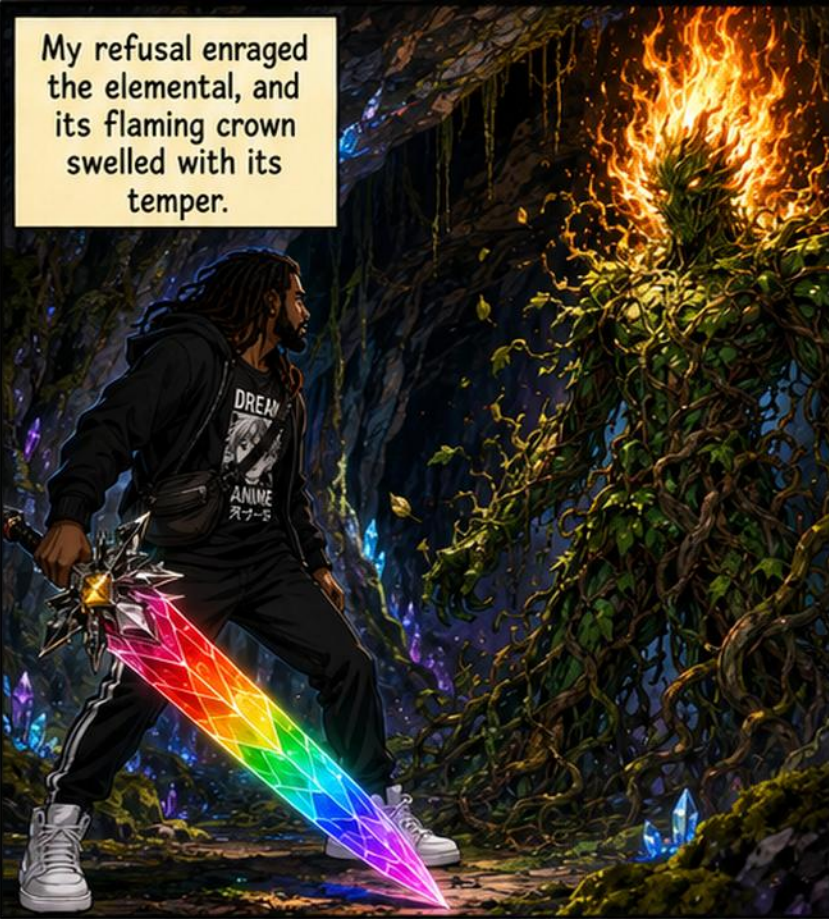
I refused to surrender one of the most powerful artifacts in the Storyverse.



Because Silonis was already in my hand, I cut through the vines and freed myself.



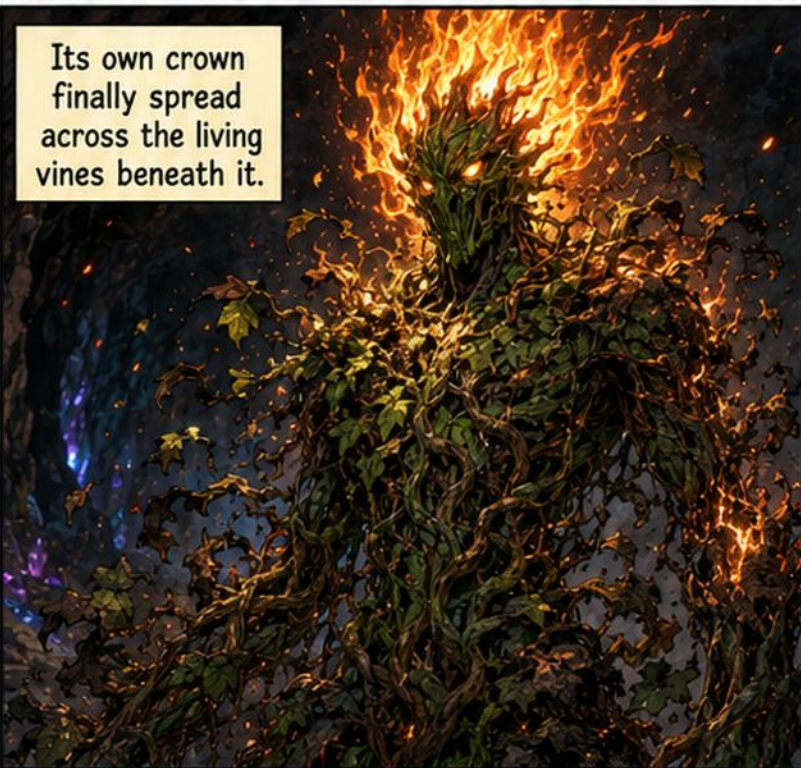
My refusal enraged the elemental, and its flaming crown swelled with its temper.



The angrier it became, the hotter and larger the fire grew.



Its own crown finally spread across the living vines beneath it.



The elemental burned its body to ash simply because I would not give it Silonis.



I realized that fire and living vines were two halves fundamentally dangerous to each other.



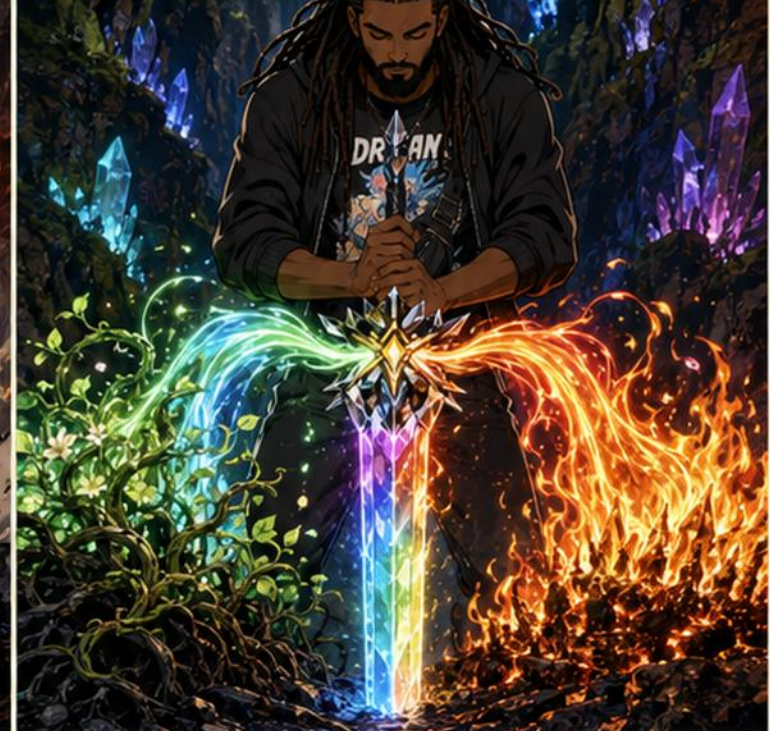
Shocked by its self-destruction, I took pity on the fallen creature and chose to help.



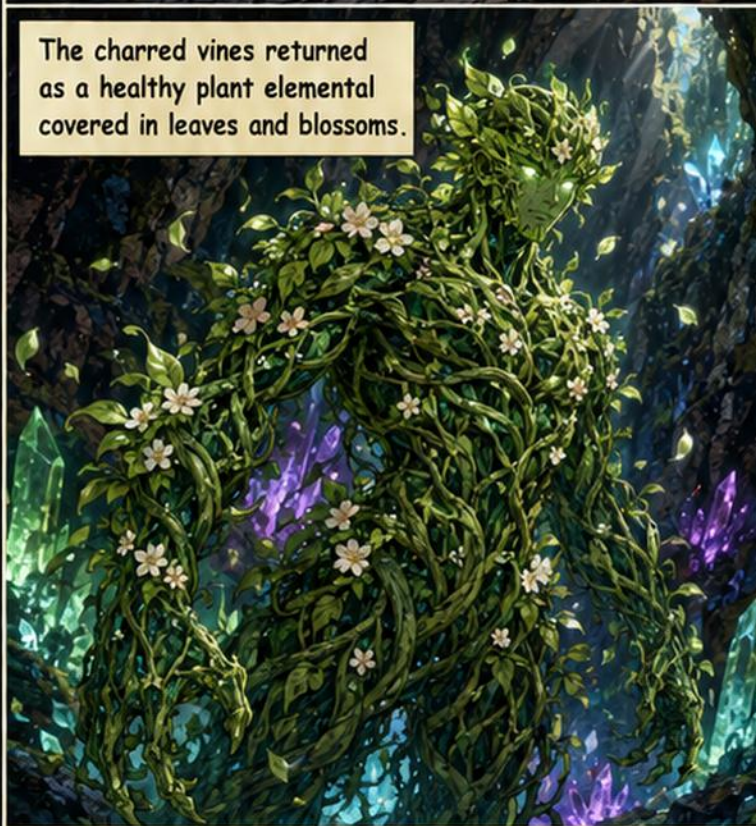
With Silonis, I separated
the burned vines from
the surviving crown of fire.



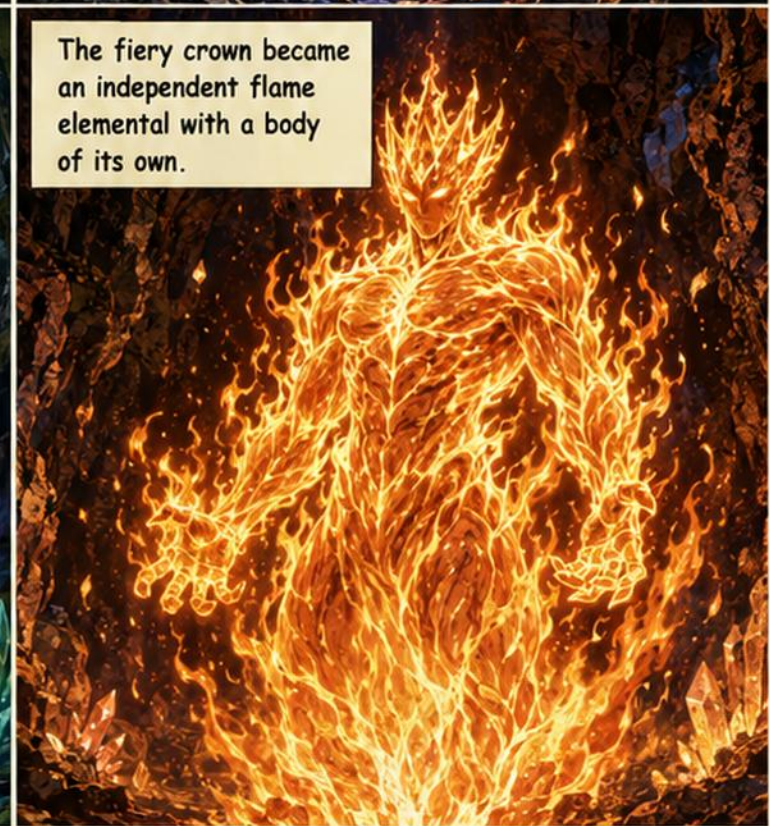
I channeled the sword's
life energy into both
incompatible halves.



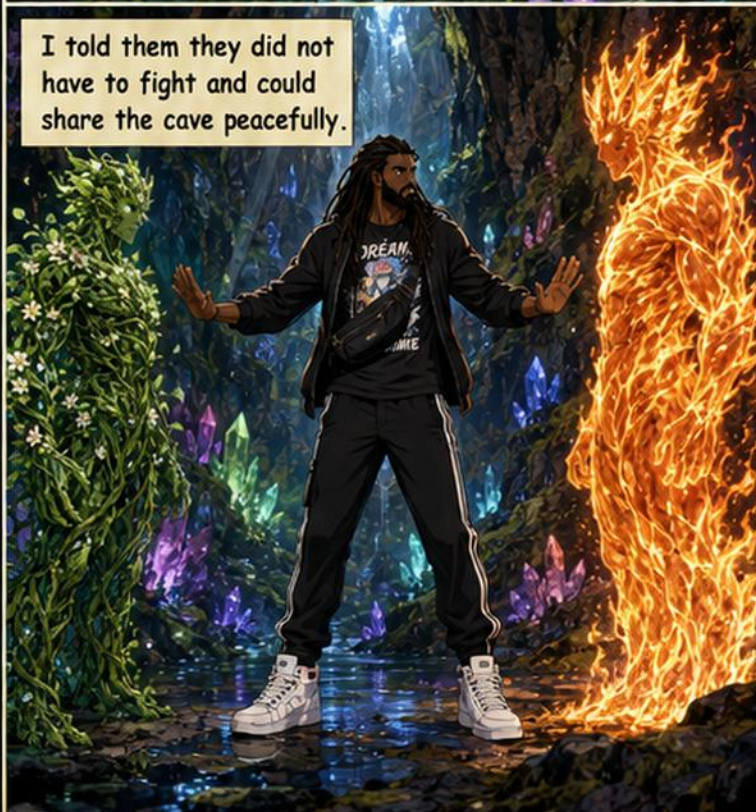
The charred vines returned
as a healthy plant elemental
covered in leaves and blossoms.



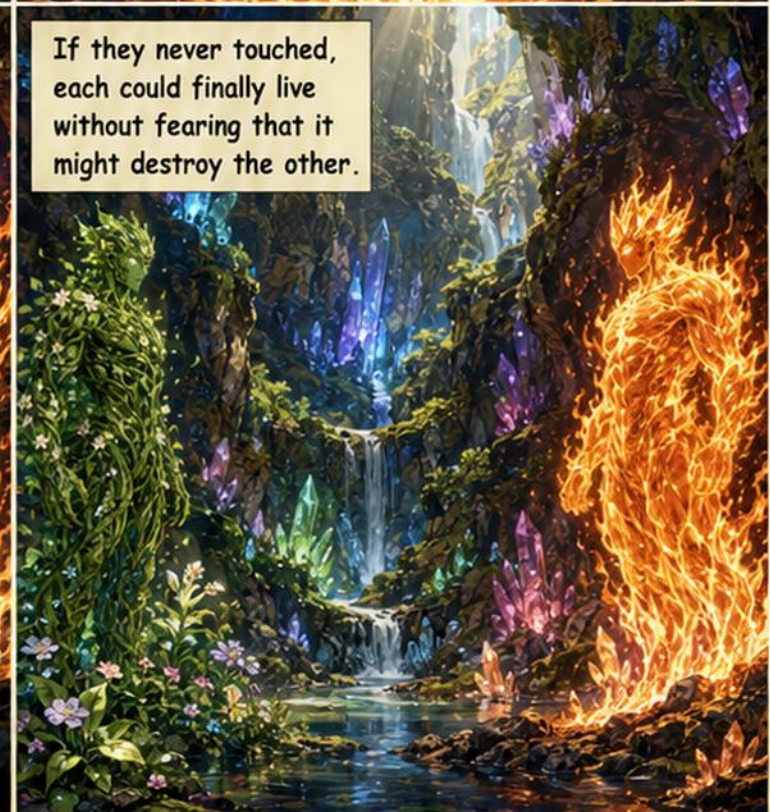
The fiery crown became
an independent flame
elemental with a body
of its own.



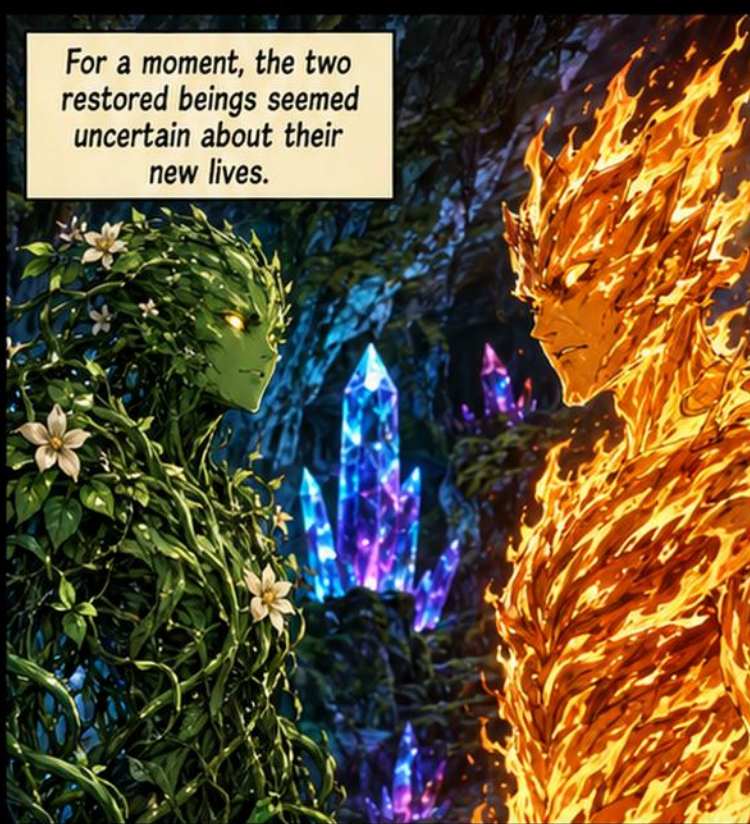
I told them they did not
have to fight and could
share the cave peacefully.



If they never touched,
each could finally live
without fearing that it
might destroy the other.



For a moment, the two restored beings seemed uncertain about their new lives.



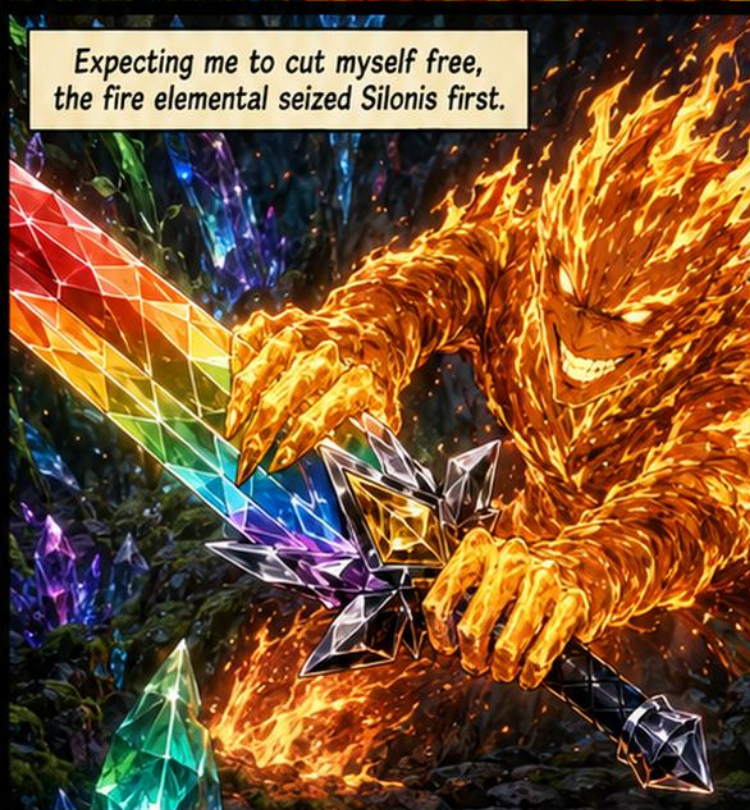
Then they looked at each other, shared mischievous smiles, and attacked the person who had saved them.



The plant elemental wrapped me in fresh vines and restrained me again.



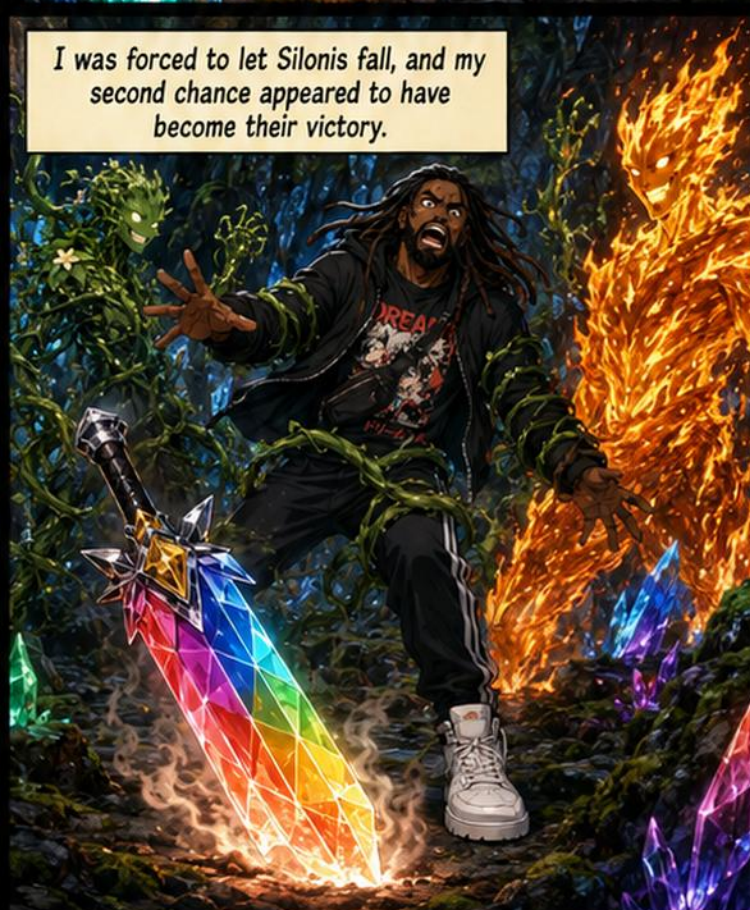
Expecting me to cut myself free, the fire elemental seized Silonis first.



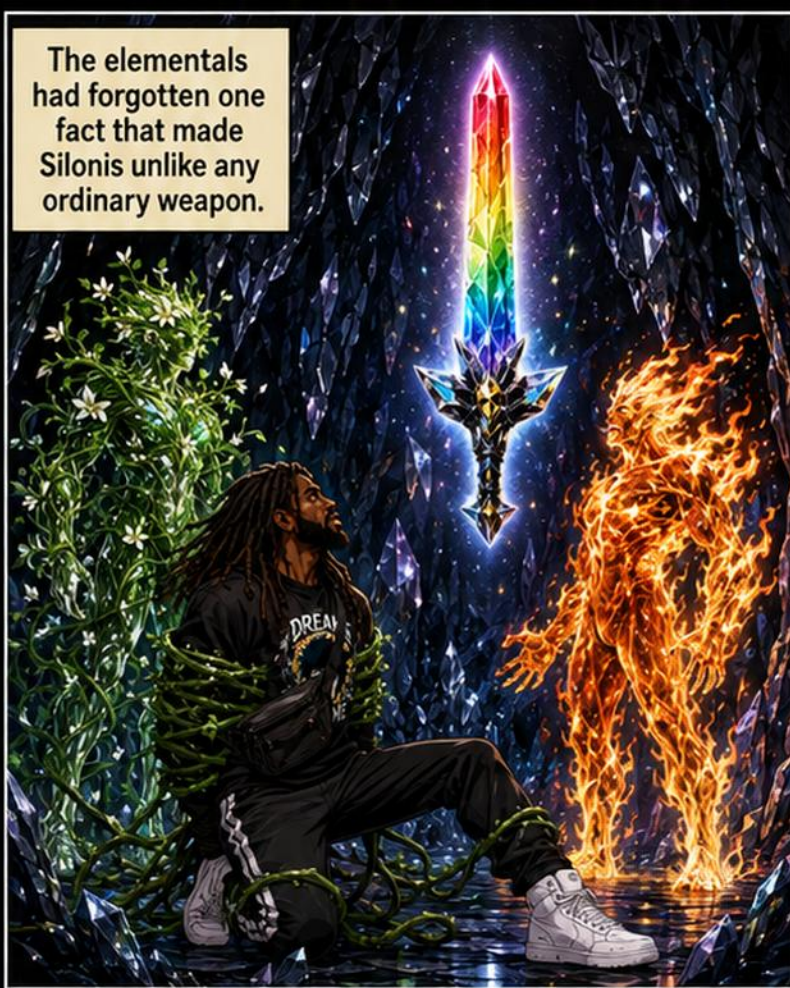
It superheated the Life Sword until even I could no longer hold the grip.



I was forced to let Silonis fall, and my second chance appeared to have become their victory.



The elementals
had forgotten one
fact that made
Silonis unlike any
ordinary weapon.



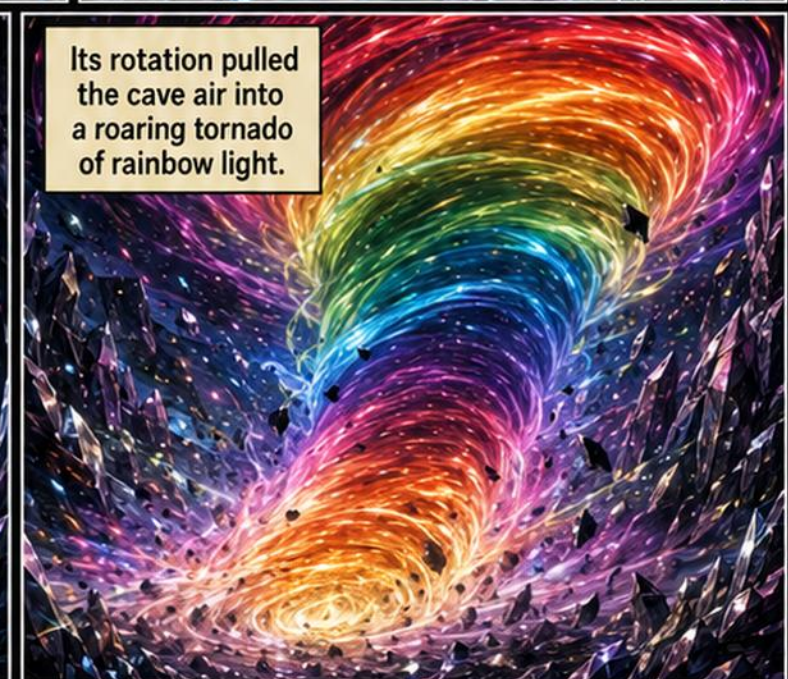
The Life Sword is alive,
and it does not need my
hand in order to act.



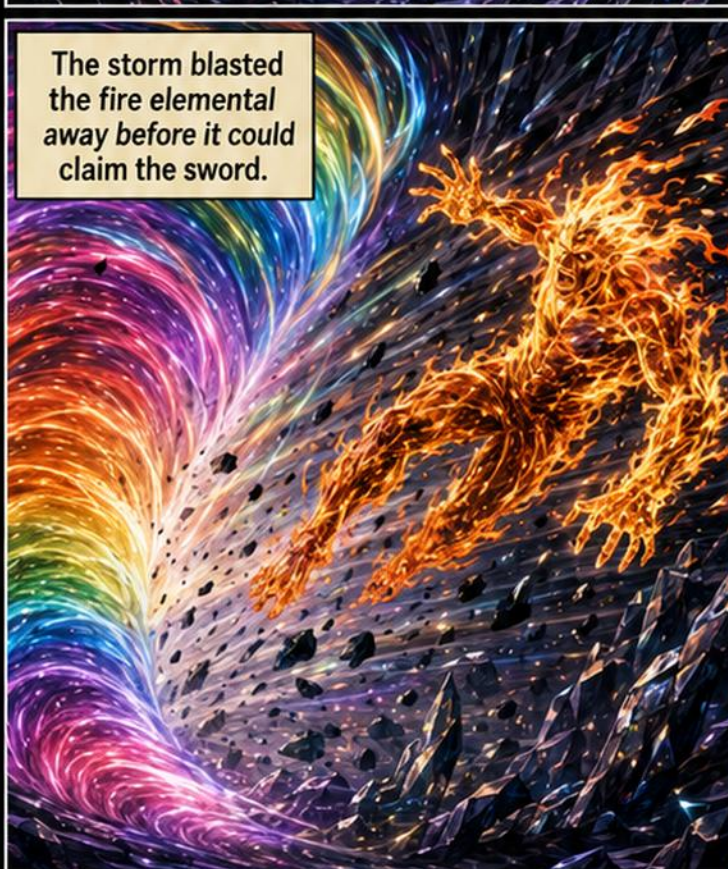
Silonis lifted itself
into the air and
began spinning like
a jet turbine.



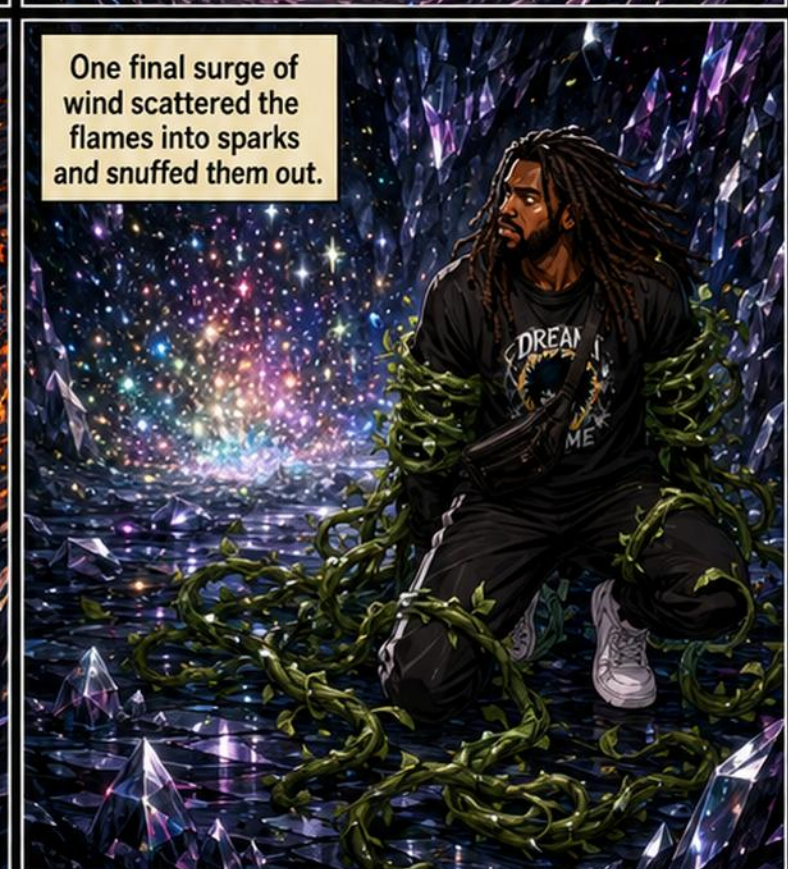
Its rotation pulled
the cave air into
a roaring tornado
of rainbow light.



The storm blasted
the fire elemental
away before it could
claim the sword.



One final surge of
wind scattered the
flames into sparks
and snuffed them out.



Silonis returned to me and restored my strength with the power of life.



A rainbow crystal barrier erupted from the blade and tore the restraining vines away.



The force field knocked the plant elemental backward and gave me room to move.



I threw Silonis toward the attacker before it could bind me a third time.



The spinning sword tore through the elemental like a crystal mulcher, scattering vines and leaves.



When the plant creature fell into pieces, Silonis flew safely back to my hand.



With both elementals defeated, I considered the effect Silonis had on the beings around me.



The original being had destroyed itself in fury when I refused to surrender the sword.



Its restored halves then risked the second lives I had given them for another chance to possess it.



I did not believe the Life Sword corrupted them, but its immense power changed their behavior.



In every Storyverse world, someone would want to hold the power of life within their own hands.



Carrying that warning with me, I flew away into the Storyverse and the dream came to an end.

